

Lesson 4 — 我爸爸在電腦公司工作

My Father Works at a Computer Company

Let's Learn Mandarin · Book 1 · Teacher's Manual

壹、教學目標 — Learning Objectives

1. Students can talk about their own lives.
 2. Students can recognize more vocabulary related to occupations and workplaces.
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貳、暖身活動 — Warm-Up Activities

1. Review the occupation vocabulary from Lessons 3 and 4 using pictures (e.g., teacher, doctor, nurse, businessman, chef, police officer, etc.). Review the grammar structures from Lessons 2 and 3: V不V (affirmative-negative questions), 都, and 在+place+V.
 2. In small groups, have students take turns asking each other occupation-related questions using the vocabulary they already know.
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參、詞語說明 — Vocabulary Notes

1. 很 (hě) — “very”

很 is used as an intensifier before adjectives and stative verbs in Mandarin. Note that in simple statements, adjectives in Mandarin typically require an adverb like 很 — a bare adjective without 很 often carries a comparative or contrastive tone.

- 他很忙。 — He is very busy.
- 她很累。 — She is very tired.

2. 喜歡 (xǐhuān) — “to like”

喜歡 can be followed by either a noun or a verb (or verb phrase).

- 喜歡 + noun: 她喜歡小孩子。 — She likes children.
- 喜歡 + verb: 她喜歡教書。 — She likes to teach.

3. 教書 (jiāo shū) — “to teach”

教書 is a separable verb compound. The verb 教 (to teach) and its object 書 (book/lessons) can be separated when a specific object is inserted:

- 她教中文。 — She teaches Chinese.
- 她喜歡教書。 — She likes to teach.

4. 每天 / 今天 (měitiān / jīntiān) — “every day / today”

These time nouns are placed before the main verb of the sentence (or after the subject). They cannot follow the verb.

- 他每天都很累。 — He is tired every day.
- 今天她不上課。 — She doesn't have class today.

5. 法文 (Fǎwén) — “French (language)”

法文 refers to the French language. Teachers should take this opportunity to also introduce:

- 中文 (Zhōngwén) — Chinese
- 英文 (Yīngwén) — English
- [Students' native language equivalent]

This helps expand students' language-name vocabulary and connects to their personal experience.

肆、句型說明 — Grammar Patterns

Grammar Pattern 1 — A不A (Affirmative-Negative Questions)

This pattern forms questions by combining the affirmative and negative forms of a verb. It is an alternative to 嗎 questions.

Pattern 1-1: S + Vs + 不 + Vs (for stative verbs)

Chinese	English
他忙不忙？	Is he busy or not?
她累不累？	Is she tired or not?
你好不好？	Are you well or not?

Pattern 1-2: S + V + 不 + V + O (for action verbs with objects)

Chinese	English
你喜歡不喜歡小孩子？	Do you like children or not?
她教不教中文？	Does she teach Chinese or not?

Pattern 1-3: 有沒有 + N

Chinese	English
你有沒有弟弟？	Do you have a younger brother or not?
他有沒有工作？	Does he have a job or not?

Teaching Tip: A不A questions cannot be combined with 嗎. Remind students these are two different ways to form yes/no questions, and only one can be used at a time.

Grammar Pattern 2 — 呢 (Elliptical Question Particle)

呢 is used to ask the same question of another person or topic when the question structure is already understood from context. It creates a “What about...?” or “And...?” type of follow-up.

Pattern: S1 + V + N, S2 + 呢？

Chinese	English
	My father is a teacher — what

我爸爸是老師，你爸爸呢？	about your father?
她喜歡教書，你呢？	She likes teaching — what about you?
我有兩個弟弟，你呢？	I have two younger brothers — what about you?

Teaching Tip: Emphasize that 呢 alone carries the full meaning of the implied question. Students do not need to repeat the full sentence — they only add 呢 after the new subject.

Grammar Pattern 3 — 的 (Possessive Marker)

Pattern 3-1: Possession

的 is placed between a pronoun/noun and the thing it possesses.

Chinese	English
我的爸爸	my father
她的工作	her job
王明文的媽媽	Wang Mingwen's mother

Pattern 3-2: Optional Omission of 的

When a personal pronoun directly precedes a noun referring to a family member or close relation, 的 is often omitted in natural speech.

With 的	Without 的	English
我的爸爸	我爸爸	my father
她的媽媽	她媽媽	her mother
你的老師	你老師	your teacher

Teaching Note: The omission is natural and common when the relationship is close or personal. In more formal or emphatic speech, 的 may be retained.

伍、課文教學 — Text Instruction

Suggested Teaching Flow

1. **Before reading:** Ask students warm-up questions based on what they already know about occupations and daily life.
2. **First listening:** Play the audio or read the dialogue aloud while students listen with books closed.
3. **Comprehension check:** Ask the following questions (see suggested questions below).
4. **Second listening/reading:** Students follow along in their books.
5. **Role-play:** Students practice the dialogue in pairs or groups.

Suggested Comprehension Questions

1. 王明美的爸爸做什麼工作？ — What does Wang Mingmei's father do?
2. 他在哪裡工作？ — Where does he work?
3. 他的工作忙不忙？ — Is his work busy or not?
4. 他每天累不累？ — Is he tired every day?
5. 王明美的媽媽做什麼工作？ — What does Wang Mingmei's mother do?
6. 她在哪裡工作？ — Where does she work?
7. 她喜歡不喜歡她的工作？ — Does she like her job or not?

8. 她喜歡小孩子嗎？ — Does she like children?
9. 她說教書累不累？ — Does she say teaching is tiring or not?
10. 你爸爸做什麼工作？ — What does your father do?
11. 你媽媽做什麼工作？ — What does your mother do?
12. 你喜歡不喜歡你的工作/學校？ — Do you like your job/school or not?

Key Sentences from the Text

- 他工作很忙。 — His work is very busy.
- 他每天都很累。 — He is tired every day.
- 她喜歡小孩子。 — She likes children.
- 她說教書不累。 — She says teaching is not tiring.

Pair Activity

Have students use the following template to ask a partner about their family members' occupations:

你__做什麼工作？他/她在哪裡工作？他/她的工作忙不忙？

陸、綜合活動 — Integrated Activities

Activity 1

Students fill in a chart about their own family members' occupations and workplaces, then share with a partner using complete sentences.

Activity 2

Students ask three classmates about their parents' or guardians' occupations and record the information. They then report to the class using 呢 follow-up questions.

Activity 3

Using the A不A pattern, students write five questions to ask a classmate. Then they take turns interviewing each other and report answers to the class.

Activity 4

Students use the possessive 的 to describe family members:

我爸爸的工作是__。他在__工作。他的工作__。

Supplementary Dialogue Template:

A: 你爸爸做什麼工作？ B: 我爸爸是__。他在__工作。 A: 他的工作忙不忙？
B: 他很忙。/ 他不太忙。 A: 你媽媽呢？ B: 我媽媽是__。

柒、補充課文 — Supplementary Texts

Supplementary Text I (Dialogue)

(A dialogue about Wang Mingmei's parents, their occupations, and daily lives. Students practice asking and answering questions about family members' jobs using the new grammar structures.)

Suggested questions for discussion after reading:

1. 王明美的爸爸在哪裡工作？ — Where does Wang Mingmei's father work?
2. 他每天很忙嗎？ — Is he very busy every day?
3. 王明美的媽媽是老師嗎？ — Is Wang Mingmei's mother a teacher?
4. 她喜歡她的工作嗎？ — Does she like her job?

Supplementary Text II (Reading Passage)

(A short reading passage about John's family, describing what his parents do for work and how they feel about their jobs.)

True/False Exercise — Answers:

#	Answer
1	✗ (False)
2	○ (True)
3	✗ (False)
4	○ (True)

捌、語音教學 — Phonetics

Initials: z, c, s

These are blade-alveolar (or dental) initials, formed by placing the tip of the tongue against the upper teeth ridge:

- **z** — unaspirated, voiced feel (like “ds” in “beds”)
- **c** — aspirated counterpart of z (like “ts” in “cats”)
- **s** — fricative (like “s” in “sun”)

Contrast with the retroflex initials zh, ch, sh from an earlier lesson (tongue tip curled back vs. forward).

Practice words: - z: 在 (zài), 怎 (zěn), 做 (zuò) - c: 才 (cái), 從 (cóng) - s: 說 (shuō → note: this is actually sh-), 三 (sān), 四 (sì)

Finals: ou, -ua, -ong

Final	Example	Meaning
ou	走 (zǒu)	to walk/leave
-ua	話 (huà)	speech/language
-ong	工 (gōng)	work

Tone Sandhi: 不 (bù)

不 is normally 4th tone (bù). However, when followed by another 4th-tone syllable, 不 changes to 2nd tone (bú):

Before 1st, 2nd, or 3rd tone	Before 4th tone
不忙 (bù máng)	不是 (bú shì)
不好 (bù hǎo)	不在 (bú zài)
不累 (bù lèi — lèi is 4th → bú lèi)	不對 (bú duì)

Teaching Tip: Drill this sandhi rule with plenty of examples, as it applies to many common expressions students already know.

玖、解答 — Answer Keys

Grammar Exercise Answers

(Answers correspond to the grammar exercises in the student textbook for Lesson 4.)

A不A Questions: Students transform 嗎 questions into A不A form and vice versa. Accept any grammatically correct affirmative-negative structure.

呢 Follow-up Questions: Students write follow-up questions using 呢. Answers will vary based on personal information.

的 (Possessive): Students fill in blanks with or without 的 as appropriate. Accept both forms where omission is optional (personal pronouns + family members).

Integrated Activity Answers

- **Activity 1:** Answers vary (personal information about family occupations).
 - **Activity 2:** Answers vary (interview results).
 - **Activity 3:** Answers vary (student-generated A不A questions).
 - **Activity 4:** Answers vary (family descriptions using 的).
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Phonetics Exercise Answers

(Refer to the student workbook. Students practice writing Pinyin with correct tones for z/c/s syllables and the finals ou, -ua, -ong. Check for correct tone sandhi application of 不.)

Workbook Answer Key

(Answers correspond to the Lesson 4 workbook exercises. Distribute or review as appropriate after completing the lesson.)

Test Answer Key

(Answers correspond to the Lesson 4 quiz provided at the end of this section.)

拾、線上資源 — Online Resources

Chinese Character Stroke Order: Students can look up the correct stroke order for new characters at: → [stroke order reference website]

Character Instructional Videos: Videos demonstrating stroke order and structure are available for the following characters introduced in Lesson 4:

- 老 (lǎo) — old / teacher (as in 老師)

- 子 (zǐ) — child / son
- 天 (tiān) — day / sky / heaven

Character Structure Activity:

Students identify the components or structure of the following characters. Answers:

Character	Pronunciation	Meaning
師	shī	teacher
忙	máng	busy
歡	huān	happy / welcome
說	shuō	to speak / to say
教	jiāo	to teach

拾壹、補充漢字 — Supplementary Character

李 (lǐ)

Meaning: plum; a common Chinese surname

Stroke order: [stroke order grid — 7 strokes]

Components: 木 (wood/tree) on bottom + 子 (child) on top

This character appears as a surname in the lesson text and is one of the most common surnames in the Chinese-speaking world.

拾貳、第四課測驗 — Lesson 4 Quiz

Lesson 4 Quiz

I. Listen and circle the correct Pinyin.

1. a. zì (b) cì (c) sì
2. a. zǒu (b) cǒu (c) sǒu
3. a. zuó (b) cuó (c) suó
4. a. zōng (b) cōng (c) sōng
5. a. zuà (b) cuà (c) suà

II. Listen and mark the tones.

1. zuo
2. cong
3. san
4. zou
5. si

III. Read aloud and write the Pinyin.

1. 做 — _____
2. 說 — _____
3. 從 — _____
4. 在 — _____
5. 四 — _____

IV. Fill in the blank with 不 or 沒 (have not / did not).

1. 她__是老師，她是醫生。

2. 他今天__來學校。
3. 我__有弟弟。
4. 你忙__忙？

V. Rewrite the following sentences as A不A questions.

1. 他很忙。→ _____？
2. 她喜歡小孩子。→ _____？
3. 你爸爸是老師。→ _____？

VI. Fill in the blank with 的 where needed. Write × if 的 is not necessary.

1. 這是我__書。
2. 她是我__媽媽。
3. 他是王明文__朋友。
4. 我__爸爸在公司工作。

VII. Write a short paragraph (3-5 sentences) about what your parent(s) or guardian(s) do for work. Use at least one A不A question structure and one 的 possessive.